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Reg.No:.....

Name:.....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-BVOC (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION November 2025
First SEMESTER
Skill Development Components (SDC)-MG1SDCTHM101-TOURISM PRODUCTS
(2025 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(1) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short answer
Answer all questions
Each question carries 2 marks

1. **Define perishability in tourism services. [U]/[C01]**

Ans: Perishability in tourism services means that tourism products such as hotel rooms, airline seats, and tour services cannot be stored for future use. If they are not used at the time of availability, the opportunity and revenue are lost.

2. **Identify two unique features of Indian wellness tourism products.[U]/[CO2]**
   Ans:
   - **Traditional healing systems** such as Ayurveda, Yoga, Siddha, and Naturopathy.
   - **Holistic approach** focusing on physical, mental, and spiritual well-being.

3. **Identify two challenges faced in the conservation of World Heritage Sites in India. [E]/[C05]**

Ans:
- Over-tourism and overcrowding, leading to physical damage.
- Lack of proper maintenance and funding for conservation activities.

4. Mention two roles of local bodies in promoting tourism at the grassroots level. [U]/[C06]

Ans:

- Development and maintenance of basic infrastructure and amenities.
- Promotion of local culture, festivals, and community-based tourism activities.

5.What is rural tourism? [U]/[CO6]

Ans: Rural tourism refers to tourism activities that take place in rural areas, offering visitors an opportunity to experience village life, local culture, traditions, agriculture, and natural surroundings.

[2x5 = 10]

Part B
short essay
Answer any 5 questions
Each question carries 5 marks

6. What is the significance of service quality in tourism? [U] / [CO1]

Ans: Service quality plays a vital role in the success of the tourism industry. High service quality ensures customer satisfaction, which leads to repeat visits and positive word-of-mouth promotion. Since tourism services are intangible, the tourist's experience depends largely on the behaviour, efficiency, and professionalism of service providers. Good service quality helps build a positive destination image, enhances customer loyalty, and gives a competitive advantage to tourism businesses. It also contributes to the overall growth and sustainability of the tourism sector.

7. Discuss the significance of community participation in the success of Swadesh Darshan projects. [K]/[CO6]

Ans: Community participation is essential for the success of Swadesh Darshan projects as it ensures sustainable and inclusive tourism development. Local communities help preserve cultural heritage, traditions, and local knowledge. Their involvement creates employment opportunities, improves livelihoods, and builds a sense of ownership toward tourism assets. Active participation also helps in maintaining infrastructure, providing authentic tourist experiences, and reducing conflicts between tourists and residents.

Overall, community participation ensures long-term success and sustainability of the project.

8. Write a short note on any two architectural heritage sites in India and their historical importance. [U]/[C05]

Ans:

Taj Mahal, Agra:

The Taj Mahal was built by Mughal Emperor Shah Jahan in memory of his wife Mumtaz Mahal. It is a symbol of love and showcases the finest Mughal architecture with intricate marble work.

Qutub Minar, Delhi:

Qutub Minar was constructed during the Delhi Sultanate period. It reflects early Indo-Islamic architecture and marks the beginning of Muslim rule in India.

9. Explain the main objectives and components of the PRASHAD Scheme. [U]/[C06]

Ans:

Objectives of PRASHAD Scheme:

- To develop pilgrimage destinations in a planned and sustainable manner
- To enhance tourist experience at spiritual destinations
- To improve infrastructure and amenities for pilgrims

Components of PRASHAD Scheme:

- Development of roads, pathways, and transport facilities
- Provision of sanitation, drinking water, and accommodation
- Improvement of tourist information centers and safety facilities

10. Describe how Ajanta and Ellora Caves represent Indian culture. [K]/[005]

Ans: Ajanta and Ellora Caves represent India's rich cultural and religious heritage. Ajanta Caves depict Buddhist themes through paintings and sculptures, reflecting ancient Indian art and philosophy. Ellora Caves showcase Buddhist, Hindu, and Jain monuments, symbolizing religious harmony and tolerance. Together, they demonstrate India's artistic excellence, spiritual diversity, and architectural skills of ancient times.

11. Write a note on yoga as a wellness product. [K]/[C03]

Ans: Yoga is an important wellness tourism product of India that focuses on physical, mental, and spiritual health. It includes practices such as asanas, pranayama, and meditation. Yoga helps reduce stress, improve flexibility, and promote inner peace. Today,

yoga retreats and wellness centers attract both domestic and international tourists, contributing significantly to India's wellness tourism sector.

12. Write a short note on Varanasi as a spiritual destination. [U]/[C04]

Ans: Varanasi is one of the oldest living cities in the world and an important spiritual center in India. Located on the banks of the River Ganga, it is considered sacred by Hindus. Pilgrims visit Varanasi for rituals, temple worship, and spiritual liberation. The ghats, temples, and religious ceremonies make Varanasi a major spiritual tourism destination.

[5x5=25]

Part C

Long essay

Answer any 1 questions

Each question carries 15 marks

13. Describe the role of Sufi shrines in India's pilgrimage tourism. [A]/[CO3, CO4

Ans: Sufi shrines play a significant role in India's pilgrimage tourism by promoting spiritual harmony and cultural unity. These shrines attract devotees from different religions, castes, and regions. Sufi saints preached messages of love, peace, and tolerance, which continue to influence society today. Major Sufi shrines are centers of religious festivals, music, and rituals such as qawwali, enhancing cultural tourism. Pilgrimage to these shrines supports local economies through tourism-related activities and strengthens India's image as a land of spiritual diversity.

14. Discuss the role of the Ministry of Tourism, Government of India, in the development and promotion of tourism in the country. [U]/[C06]

Ans: The Ministry of Tourism plays a vital role in the development and promotion of tourism in India. It formulates tourism policies and implements schemes such as Swadesh Darshan and PRASHAD to improve infrastructure and destination development. The ministry promotes India globally through campaigns like "Incredible India." It also supports skill development, capacity building, and sustainable tourism practices. By coordinating with state governments and private stakeholders, the ministry contributes to employment generation, economic growth, and the overall development of the tourism sector.

[15x1=15]